

NEXARION SOLUTIONS, INC.

Remote Work & Technology Policy Supplement

Version 3.0 | Effective March 1, 2025

IT & Information Security Division | Supplements Employee Handbook Sections
5.3 & 12

This supplement provides detailed operational guidance that expands on Handbook Sections 5.3 (Remote & Hybrid Work Policy) and Section 12 (Technology, Data & Confidentiality). Where this supplement is more specific than the Handbook, this supplement controls. All employees - remote, hybrid, or on-site - must comply with the technology and data sections of this document.

Section 1: Home Office & Remote Work Requirements

1.1 Home Office Standards

Employees approved for remote or hybrid work must maintain a home office environment that meets the following minimum standards. Nexarion may request a self-certification attestation or, in certain cases, a video walkthrough with the employee's manager or a Facilities representative.

- **Dedicated Workspace:** A separate, private space (does not need to be a dedicated room, but must have a door or privacy barrier) where confidential work can be conducted without risk of being overheard.
- **Internet Connectivity:** Broadband internet with minimum 50 Mbps download and 15 Mbps upload. Employees must test and document their speed at setup using Nexarion's approved tool (speedtest.nexarionsolutions.com/verify). Satellite internet (including Starlink) requires IT pre-approval due to latency concerns on VoIP and video platforms.
- **Ergonomics:** A desk or dedicated surface and a chair that supports proper posture. Prolonged work from a couch, bed, or kitchen counter is not permitted during client calls or video meetings.
- **Background / Privacy:** During video meetings, employees must use either a physical background, a professional virtual background, or ensure their visible environment is professional and free from confidential materials of other clients or personal information.
- **Lighting:** Adequate lighting for video calls. Backlit setups (window directly behind the employee) that obscure the employee's face are not acceptable for client-facing calls.

1.2 Equipment Provided by Nexarion

Item	Provided ?	Spec / Model (Standard)	Employee Responsibility
Laptop	Yes	Dell Latitude 5540 (PC) or MacBook Pro 14" M3 (Mac role)	Keep updated; report damage within 24 hours
VPN Client	Yes (pre-installed)	Palo Alto GlobalProtect	Must be connected whenever accessing Company systems
Webcam (external)	Yes - remote-only employees	Logitech C920s HD Pro	Do not use for personal streaming or non-work purposes
Headset	Yes - remote-only employees	Jabra Evolve2 30	Keep charged; use on all client calls
Monitor (external)	No - must use stipend	N/A	Stipend available (see Section 1.3)

Mobile phone	No (unless Director+)	N/A	Personal device may be enrolled in MDM (optional)
Docking station	No - must use stipend	N/A	Stipend available (see Section 1.3)

1.3 Home Office Setup Stipend - Expanded Detail

The Employee Handbook (Section 5.3) references a one-time \$400 home office setup stipend. The following provides the complete policy details:

Item Category	Eligible?	Per-Item Cap	Notes
External monitor	Yes	\$350	Maximum 1 monitor reimbursed
Monitor stand / arm	Yes	\$80	Must be purchased with monitor in same claim
Docking station	Yes	\$120	Compatible with Nexarion-issued laptop only
Keyboard and mouse	Yes	\$80 combined	Ergonomic models qualify
Desk lamp	Yes	\$50	Must be LED; no smart/WiFi-connected lamps
Webcam (personal)	Yes	\$90	Only if company webcam not provided (on-site staff)
Headset (personal)	Yes	\$100	Only if company headset not provided
Standing desk / converter	Yes	\$150	Desk converter only; full desks not covered
Office chair	No	N/A	Not covered under setup stipend
Internet router or equipment	No	N/A	Employee responsibility
Printer or scanner	No	N/A	All printing via Company office or approved vendor

Receipts must be submitted within 90 days of the remote arrangement start date using ADP Expense category code HO-SETUP. The \$400 cap is a total cap across all categories combined. Unused stipend does not roll over and has no cash value. Employees who voluntarily resign within 6 months of receiving the stipend must repay 50% of the reimbursed amount.

1.4 Internet Reimbursement

SUPPLEMENT TO HANDBOOK SECTION 5.3: The Handbook states that Nexarion does not reimburse ongoing internet costs unless the employee is in a role formally designated as Fully Remote Exempt (FRE). The following roles are currently designated FRE and receive a monthly internet reimbursement of \$60/month (requires monthly receipt submission): (1) All roles in the Managed Services delivery team, (2) Remote Technical Support Specialists (Tier 2 and above), (3) Remote Data Center Operations Analysts. All other remote and hybrid employees are NOT eligible for internet reimbursement regardless of remote work frequency. FRE designation is assigned by the VP of IT Operations and reviewed annually.

Section 2: Technology Acceptable Use - Detailed Policies

2.1 VPN Requirements

All employees - remote and on-site - must use the Company VPN (Palo Alto GlobalProtect) whenever accessing any Nexarion system, including email, internal applications, client portals, and cloud storage. VPN is not optional for remote employees. The following specific rules apply:

- VPN must be active before opening any Nexarion application. Split-tunneling is disabled; all traffic routes through the Company VPN while connected.
- Connecting to a public Wi-Fi network (coffee shop, airport, hotel) without VPN active is a policy violation and must be reported to IT within 2 hours.
- VPN access is tied to the employee's personal device certificate. Sharing VPN credentials with any other person is a terminable offense.
- VPN sessions auto-terminate after 8 hours of inactivity. Employees should not attempt to circumvent auto-termination.

2.2 Password & Authentication Policy

Requirement	Standard
Minimum password length	16 characters
Complexity requirement	Must include uppercase, lowercase, number, and special character
Password expiration	Every 180 days (with MFA); every 90 days (without MFA)
MFA requirement	Mandatory for all employees on all systems as of January 1, 2025
MFA method	Microsoft Authenticator app (preferred); hardware FIDO2 key (approved alternative)
Password reuse	Cannot reuse last 12 passwords
Password manager	Nexarion-provided 1Password Teams account; personal password managers prohibited for work credentials
Shared/service account passwords	Rotated every 90 days; stored in CyberArk PAM; never shared via email or chat

2.3 Approved AI Tools Policy

The proliferation of generative AI tools presents both productivity opportunities and significant data security risks. The following policy governs AI tool usage for all Nexarion employees. Unauthorized use of AI tools with Company or client data is a serious policy violation subject to disciplinary action under Handbook Section 10.

Tool	Status	Approved Users	Approval Process	Data Restrictions
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GitHub Copilot (Business)	APPROVE D	Software Engineers, DevOps Engineers	Pre-approved; IT provisions access	No client data in prompts; internal code only
Claude for Work (Anthropic)	APPROVE D	Data Analysts, BI Analysts, Strategy team	Submit IT-2025-AI form; manager approval required	No client PII; no confidential financial data
Microsoft 365 Copilot	APPROVE D	All employees (licensed users)	Pre-approved via M365 license	Subject to Microsoft data processing terms; no client data beyond M365 tenant
ChatGPT (OpenAI) - Free or Plus	RESTRICT ED	None (prohibited for work use)	Not available for work use	PROHIBITED - data not private; no opt-out for model training
Google Gemini (personal account)	RESTRICT ED	None (prohibited for work use)	Not available for work use	PROHIBITED - use Google Workspace Gemini only (see below)
Google Workspace Gemini	APPROVE D	Employees with Google Workspace license	Pre-approved	Subject to Google Workspace DPA; no client PII
Midjourney, DALL-E, image generators	RESTRICT ED	Marketing team only with Legal approval	Case-by-case Legal review required	No client logos, branding, or copyrighted material
Any unlisted AI tool	PROHIBIT ED by default	N/A	Must submit IT-2025-AI for review; 10 business day SLA	No use until approved

Form IT-2025-AI is available on the IT self-service portal at it.nexarionsolutions.com. Approval requires: (1) employee's manager sign-off, (2) description of intended use case, (3) confirmation of data types to be used. IT will respond within 10 business days. Provisional use is NOT permitted while approval is pending.

2.4 Equipment Loss, Damage & Return Policy

Nexarion-issued equipment is Company property. Employees are responsible for its safekeeping. The following financial responsibility schedule applies:

Situation	Employee Financial Responsibility	Process
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Accidental damage (first occurrence)	\$150 deductible; Company covers remainder	Report within 24 hours via IT ticket; IT arranges repair/replacement
Accidental damage (second occurrence within 24 months)	\$300 deductible	Same as above; manager notified
Negligent damage (e.g., liquid spill, dropping in pool)	50% of replacement cost (up to \$600)	IT assessment required; HR notified
Theft (police report filed within 24 hours)	\$0 employee responsibility	File police report; provide report number to IT immediately
Theft (no police report)	Full replacement cost	IT and HR notified; may result in disciplinary action
Equipment not returned within 5 business days of separation	Full replacement cost deducted from final paycheck (where permitted by law)	IT sends certified mail notice; Legal initiates recovery if needed
Loss (not theft)	Full replacement cost	Manager and IT must be notified same day

Section 3: Data Security & Incident Response

3.1 Data Classification Handling Requirements - Expanded

This section expands on the data classification table in Handbook Section 12.2 with specific technical handling requirements.

Classification	At-Rest Encryption	In-Transit Encryption	Storage Locations Permitted	Sharing Requirements
Confidential	AES-256 required	TLS 1.2+ required	Nexarion SharePoint, Nexarion OneDrive, approved client portal only	Executed NDA + IT-approved secure file transfer (ShareFile); email attachment prohibited
Internal Use Only	Standard OS encryption	TLS 1.2+ preferred	Nexarion M365 tenant, approved internal tools	Internal email OK; external email requires manager approval
Public	Not required	Not required	Any approved platform	No restrictions

3.2 Security Incident Response Procedure

A security incident is any event that compromises or potentially compromises the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of Nexarion or client data. All employees must be familiar with and follow the Nexarion Incident Response Procedure (IRP).

Step	Action Required	Timeframe	Responsible Party
1. Detect	Identify the potential incident. Do not attempt to investigate or remediate on your own.	Immediately upon awareness	Any employee
2. Report	Call IT Security Hotline: (404) 555-0911 (24/7). Do not use email for initial report.	Within 1 hour of detection	Employee who detects incident
3. Contain	IT Security will direct containment steps. Follow instructions exactly. Do not power off device unless instructed.	Within 2 hours of report	IT Security + Employee
4. Preserve	Do not delete files, emails, or logs related to the incident. Preserve all evidence.	Ongoing until cleared by IT Security	Employee

5. Notify HR/Legal	IT Security notifies HR and Legal. Employee may be required to provide a written statement.	Within 4 hours of confirmed incident	IT Security
6. Client Notification (if applicable)	Legal and Client Services determine if client notification is required. State breach notification laws may apply (72-hour requirement in some states).	Within 24-72 hours (state-dependent)	Legal + Client Services
7. Post-Incident Review	Root cause analysis and corrective action plan developed by IT Security.	Within 10 business days	IT Security + Manager

IT Security Hotline: (404) 555-0911 - Available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. For phishing emails: do not click any links; forward the email as an attachment to phishing@nexarionsolutions.com and then delete it. Do not warn colleagues via the same email chain - use Teams or phone instead.

3.3 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Policy

Nexarion does not generally support BYOD for primary work functions. Personal devices may access Nexarion email via Outlook Mobile and Microsoft Teams only, subject to enrollment in Nexarion's Mobile Device Management (MDM) solution (Microsoft Intune). MDM enrollment on a personal device enables IT to:

- Enforce PIN/biometric lock and device encryption.
- Remotely wipe Nexarion application data (NOT personal data) in the event of loss or termination.
- Monitor Nexarion application usage (not personal app usage).
- Enforce VPN for Nexarion app traffic.

BYOD enrollment is voluntary. Employees who choose not to enroll their personal device may not access Nexarion email or Teams on that device. Company-issued devices remain the required primary work tool for all employees. Nexarion will never remotely access, view, or delete personal photos, apps, or data on an enrolled personal device.

Section 4: Remote Work Conduct & Availability Standards

4.1 Availability and Response Time Standards

Remote employees are held to the same responsiveness standards as on-site employees during core hours (10:00 AM - 3:00 PM local time). The following specific response time standards apply:

Channel	Expected Response Time (Core Hours)	Expected Response Time (Non-Core Hours)	Notes
Microsoft Teams (direct message)	Within 15 minutes	Not required	Status must be set accurately (Available/Busy/Away)
Email	Within 2 hours	Not required (unless on-call)	Out-of-office auto-reply required for planned absences of 4+ hours
Phone (work or personal - Teams call)	Within 30 minutes	Not required	Voicemail must be set up and checked daily
Client-facing channels (email, portal)	Within 1 hour	Per client SLA (check your engagement letter)	Client SLAs override these standards
Manager request (any channel)	Within 30 minutes (core hours)	Best effort; within 1 hour if urgent	Escalation to skip-level if not reachable after 1 hour

4.2 Time Tracking for Non-Exempt Remote Employees

Non-exempt remote employees must track all time worked using Nexarion's time tracking system (ADP Time & Attendance). The following rules apply:

- Clock in and out must occur at the start and end of each work session, including after meal breaks.
- Time must be submitted and manager-approved by midnight on Sunday of each workweek.
- Rounding: ADP rounds to the nearest 6-minute increment. Do not manually adjust time to compensate for rounding.
- Off-the-clock work is prohibited. If a manager requests work outside tracked hours, report this to HR immediately.
- Inaccurate time entry (including under-reporting hours to avoid overtime) is a policy violation subject to discipline.

4.3 Remote Work Revocation Process

The Employee Handbook (Section 5.3) states that remote work may be revoked with as little as 5 business days' notice. The following additional detail applies:

Revocation Reason	Minimum Notice	Appeal Process
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Business/operational need (restructuring, client requirement)	5 business days	No appeal; business decision
Performance concern (not meeting productivity standards)	5 business days (simultaneous with or following documented warning)	Employee may submit written response to HR within 5 days
Policy violation (e.g., VPN non-compliance, availability failure)	Immediate revocation possible; written notice within 24 hours	Employee may submit written response; HR reviews within 10 days
Voluntary role change (promotion, transfer to different team)	Determined by new manager; minimum 2 weeks from role change date	Discuss with new manager and HR
Company-wide return-to-office mandate	Minimum 30 days notice company-wide	No individual appeal; FMLA/ADA accommodations excepted

IT Helpdesk: helpdesk@nexarionsolutions.com | Ext. 5-HELP | IT Security: (404) 555-0911 (24/7) | it.nexarionsolutions.com